

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250276827

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 04, 2025

Inventor(s)

Markman; Austin

Multi-function wipe container with integrated knife or straightedge cleaning lid

Abstract

The present disclosure relates to a novel and innovative knife cleaning solution or system. The disclosed system pertains to a specialized lid designed for wipes' containers, specifically catering to the needs of chefs and home cooks for safe and on-the-spot knife cleaning. The lid offers a unique and versatile layout, enabling efficient knife cleaning while also containing the waste generated during the process. Additionally, the lid is adaptable and can be used with various types of wipes packaging, enhancing its usability and convenience.

Inventors: Markman; Austin (Georgetown, TX)

Applicant: Markman; Austin (Georgetown, TX)

Family ID: 94389012

Appl. No.: 19/213496

Filed: May 20, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

parent US division 18229129 20230801 parent-grant-document US 12338040 child US 19213496

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: B65D5/72 (20060101); A47K10/32 (20060101); A47L21/00 (20060101); A47L21/04 (20060101); B08B1/14 (20240101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC B65D5/727 (20130101); B08B1/143 (20240101); A47K10/32 (20130101); A47K2010/3266 (20130101); A47L21/00 (20130101); A47L21/04 (20130101)

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

[0001] Not applicable.

STATEMENT REGARDING FEDERALLY SPONSORED RESEARCH OR DEVELOPMENT

[0002] Not applicable.

THE NAMES OF THE PARTIES TO A JOINT RESEARCH AGREEMENT

[0003] Not applicable.

REFERENCE TO AN APPENDIX SUBMITTED ON A COMPACT DISC AND

INCORPORATED BY REFERENCE OF THE MATERIAL ON THE COMPACT DISC

[0004] Not applicable.

STATEMENT REGARDING PRIOR DISCLOSURES BY THE INVENTOR OR A JOINT INVENTOR

[0005] A product embodying the disclosed invention was trademarked SANIKNIVES and first used as early as 06/00/2023 before being introduced to commerce of the United States at least as early as Jun. 29, 2023. This prior public disclosure is identified in U.S. Trademark application Ser. No. 98/077,251 for SANIKNIVES. Hereinafter the invention may be referred to as SANIKNIVES™.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Field of Invention

[0006] The disclosed subject matter is in the field of systems and apparatus for cleaning straight edges or knives.

Background of the Invention

[0007] Knives and straight edges are common tools in the culinary world. Thus, the efficient and safe cleaning of knives and other straight-edge cutting or cooking tools is of utmost importance to maintain hygiene and prevent cross-contamination of foods or flavors during food preparation. Chefs and home cooks often encounter the challenge of needing to quickly clean their knives and on the spot between different food cuts. The goal of cleaning a knife on the spot is ensuring that no residual flavors or contaminants from prior cuts remain on the blade. The conventional methods of cleaning knives using sinks and washcloths are most often inconvenient, time-consuming, and may not guarantee complete sanitation.

[0008] Traditional knife-cleaning techniques or systems also present safety hazards because the process of wiping the blade on a cloth or using the fingers to clean the blade exposes users to the risk of cuts and injuries. Moreover, the waste and debris cleaned off the knife during these procedures are often left uncontained, leading to potential contamination of the surrounding workspace and the knife itself.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0009] To address these challenges and enhance the safety and efficiency of knife cleaning, the disclosed SANIKNIVES™ system, apparatus, and related methods have been proposed. Suitably, SANIKNIVES™ is a multi-function wipe container with an integrated knife or straight-edge cleaning lid that improves the state of the art as to the way knives are cleaned in both professional kitchens and home settings.

[0010] An objective of SANIKNIVES™ disclosure is to provide chefs and cooks with a quick, on-the-spot, and safe method for cleaning knives between different food cuts. By combining a wipe container with a specially designed lid, SANIKNIVES™ eliminates the need for traditional cleaning methods and mitigates the risk of injuries associated with handling knives directly.

[0011] The layout of the SANIKNIVES™ lid is a key to the proposed lid's functionality. The lid features an annular base that attaches securely to the top rim of the wipe container, enabling easy

access to the wipes. A cover plate is hinged to the base, providing a protective seal to close the container and safeguard the wipes from moisture, moisture-loss, and contaminants. Additionally, a cleaning plate is integrated into the cover plate, creating a convenient and safe platform for cleaning knives.

[0012] During use, the cover plate may be opened via a user-friendly tab, revealing the annulus of the annular base, from which individual wipes can be dispensed. The cover plate is equipped with an annular projection and a latch that respectively interact with an annulus and catch of the base, ensuring a secure closure to preserve wipe freshness.

[0013] The cleaning plate is strategically positioned to open in a transverse direction relative to the cover plate, allowing the user to secure a wipe over the cover and cleaning plates via biting the wipe between teeth and a tab of the cleaning plate. With the tab securely hinged to the teeth to accomplish the biting action, the wipe is held in place, creating a safe and effective platform for cleaning knives or straight edges. By placing a knife on the wipe so that the knife is held by the cover plate and closing the cleaning plate over the wipe and cover plate, the knife or straight edge will be sandwiched between the cleaning plate and cover plate such that the user can pull the knife through the wipe to wipe off any waste or debris, effectively containing the contaminants of the blade within the wipe and preventing cross-contamination. The process ensures that the knife remains sanitary and ready for the next cut, enhancing efficiency and food safety.

[0014] SANIKNIVES™ addresses the critical need for safe, quick, and on-the-spot knife cleaning in culinary or other settings. By integrating a wipe container with a specialized cleaning lid, SANIKNIVES™ offers a hygienic solution that effectively contains the waste wiped off the knife while preventing the cross-contamination of foods. This innovation represents a significant advancement in kitchen hygiene and safety for the benefit of both professional chefs and home cooks alike.

[0015] Some of the features of the disclosed technology include:

Dual-Hinged Lid:

SANIKNIVES™ features a unique dual-hinged lid that serves multiple purposes. Firstly, SANIKNIVES™ facilitates easy dispensing of sanitation wipes, ensuring quick access to a clean wipe for knife cleaning. Secondly, the lid provides finger protection during use, safeguarding users from potential cuts or injuries while handling sharp objects.

Portable and Disposable Design:

SANIKNIVES™ is laid-out for portability, making SANIKNIVES™ an ideal companion for chefs and home cooks alike. SANIKNIVES™'s disposable nature ensures a fresh and sanitary cleaning experience every time, eliminating the need for cumbersome and potentially unhygienic reusable knife cleaning solutions.

Built-In Cut Guard:

The apparatus incorporates a sharp guard within the lid's second compartment, creating a safe enclosure for knives during sanitation. This guard prevents accidental contact with the knife's edge and mitigates the risk of injury while storing or disposing of used wipes.

Versatility:

SANIKNIVES™'s layout allows it to accommodate a wide range of sharp objects, not limited to knives alone. It can effectively sanitize other sharp tools, such as scissors, box cutters, and utility knives, making it a versatile solution for various applications.

Efficient Wipe Dispensing:

The apparatus ensures efficient and controlled wipe dispensing, reducing wastage and optimizing the usage of sanitation wipes, thereby extending their lifespan.

Description of Prior Art

[0016] Prior art knife cleaning methods and multi-use wipe dispensers faced various challenges that compromised efficiency and hygiene in culinary settings.

[0017] Knife Cleaning Prior Art: Various knife cleaning methods have been used in the past, such

as wiping the blade on a cloth or using fingers, which posed safety risks due to the direct handling of sharp blades. U.S. Pat. No. 2,140,209 (issued 1938) by Rietveld disclosed a “knife blade cleaner,” but it did not employ wipes and lacked a comprehensive solution for efficient knife cleaning. Similarly, U.S. Pat. No. 2,707,299 (issued 1955) by Steindorf et al. disclosed “spatula cleaners,” which slid knives between two surfaces, but did not offer a mechanism for containing the waste. The prior art lacked a dedicated and efficient knife-cleaning tool, leaving chefs and home cooks susceptible to cross-contamination and time-consuming cleaning processes.

[0018] Multi-Use Wipe Dispenser Prior Art: Certain multi-use wipe dispensers, such as U.S. Pat. No. 6,836,920 (issued 2005) by Scannell, offered a “plastic pop-top can lip cleaner” with a package of cleaning wipes. However, it was not designed specifically for knife cleaning, and the wipes did not efficiently contain the waste from the can's lip. Additionally, U.S. Pat. No. 9,630,765 (issued 2017) by Nelson disclosed a “combination deodorant/antiperspirant and moist wipes container,” but it did not address the unique requirements of knife cleaning. The generic multi-use wipe dispensers lacked the necessary features to ensure a comprehensive and sanitary knife cleaning process.

[0019] State of the art: The prior art demonstrates a need for a safe, fast, and on-the-spot knife cleaning method that would prevent cross-contamination between different food cuts while ensuring user safety. Traditional cleaning methods posed risks of injury and were time-consuming, while generic multi-use wipe dispensers lacked the necessary functionalities for efficient and effective knife or straight edge cleaning.

[0020] Improvement: SANIKNIVES™ offers an innovative and practical solution to the problems presented by the prior art. SANIKNIVES™ is a multi-function wipe container with an integrated knife-cleaning lid, designed to revolutionize knife cleaning practices and enhance kitchen hygiene.

[0021] A feature of SANIKNIVES™ is a specialized lid, which addresses the shortcomings of traditional knife cleaning methods and generic multi-use wipe dispensers. The annular base of the lid securely attaches to the wipe container, allowing easy access to individual wipes for convenient use. The cover plate, hingedly connected to the base, provides a protective seal to safeguard the wipes from moisture and contaminants, ensuring their freshness and effectiveness.

[0022] The cleaning plate, integrated into the cover plate, serves as a dedicated platform for knife cleaning. The transverse opening and user-friendly tab on the cleaning plate enable safe and quick access to wipe the knife blade effectively. By sandwiching the knife between the cleaning plate and cover plate and using the wipe, the waste and debris from the knife are effectively contained within the wipe. This prevents cross-contamination and ensures that the knife remains sanitary and ready for the next use.

[0023] SANIKNIVES™ confronts the limitations of the prior art by providing a specialized, multi-use wipe dispenser with a knife-cleaning lid. SANIKNIVES™ offers a fast, safe, and on-the-spot knife cleaning solution, promoting kitchen hygiene and food safety in both professional and home culinary environments. SANIKNIVES™'s unique layout sets it apart from traditional knife cleaning methods and generic multi-use wipe dispensers, making it a highly efficient and essential tool for chefs and cooks worldwide.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWINGS

[0024] Other objectives of the disclosure will become apparent to those skilled in the art once the invention has been shown and described. The way these objectives and other desirable characteristics can be obtained is explained in the following description and attached figures in which:

[0025] FIG. 1A—Perspective view of wipes' container **1000** with a straightedge-cleaning lid **2000**.

[0026] FIG. 1B—Another perspective view of the wipes' container **1000** with the straightedge-cleaning lid **2000** in a closed configuration relative to the base.

[0027] FIG. 1C—Perspective view of the wipes' container **1000** with the straightedge-cleaning lid **2000** wherein the cover plate **2200** is in an open configuration relative to the base.

[0028] FIG. 1D—Perspective view of the wipes' container **1000** with the straightedge-cleaning lid **2000** wherein the cover plate **2200** is in an open configuration relative to the base.

[0029] FIG. 1E—Another perspective view of the wipes' container **1000** with the straightedge-cleaning lid **2000** in a closed configuration relative to the base.

[0030] FIG. 2A—Another perspective view of the wipes' container **1000** with the straightedge-cleaning lid **2000** in a closed configuration relative to the base.

[0031] FIG. 2B—Perspective view of the wipes' container **1000** with the straightedge-cleaning lid **2000** wherein the cleaning plate **2300** is in an open configuration relative to the cover plate **2200**.

[0032] FIG. 3—Top perspective view of the lid **2000** in an open configuration of the cover plate and open configuration of the cleaning plate.

[0033] FIG. 4—Top plan view of the lid **2000** in an open configuration of the cover plate and open configuration of the cleaning plate.

[0034] FIG. 5—Bottom perspective view of the cover plate in an open configuration and cleaning plate in an open configuration.

[0035] FIG. 6—Bottom plan view of the lid **2000** in an open configuration of the cover plate and open configuration of the cleaning plate.

[0036] FIG. 7A—Another perspective view of the wipes' container **1000** with the straightedge-cleaning lid **2000** in a closed configuration relative to the base.

[0037] FIG. 7B—Another perspective view of the wipes' container **1000** with the straightedge-cleaning lid **2000** in a closed configuration relative to the base.

[0038] FIG. 7C—Another perspective view of the wipes' container **1000** with the straightedge-cleaning lid **2000** in an open configuration relative to the cover plate **2200**.

[0039] FIG. 7D—Another perspective view of the wipes' container **1000** with the straightedge-cleaning lid **2000** in an open configuration relative to the cover plate **2200**.

[0040] FIG. 8A—Plan view of the lid **2000** in an open configuration relative to the cover plate, showing the cleaning plate mouth open.

[0041] FIG. 8B—Plan view of the lid **2000** in an open configuration relative to the cover plate, showing the cleaning plate mouth closed.

[0042] FIG. 9—Illustration of wiping the knife or straightedge **5000** on the cover and cleaning plates.

[0043] FIG. 10A—Illustration of cleaning the knife or straightedge **5000** between the cover and cleaning plates, with the wipe **3000** folded over the knife.

[0044] FIG. 10B—Illustration of cleaning the knife or straightedge **5000** between the cover and cleaning plates, with the waste wiped off contained within the wipe.

[0045] FIG. 11—Alternative embodiment of the knife or straightedge cleaning lid **2000** in a rectangular shape.

[0046] FIG. 12—Top perspective view of the alternative embodiment of the lid **2000** in an open configuration of the cover plate and open configuration of the cleaning plate.

[0047] FIG. 13—Bottom perspective view of the alternative embodiment of the lid **2000** in an open configuration of the cover plate and open configuration of the cleaning plate.

[0048] FIG. 14—Side view of the alternative embodiment of the lid depicted in FIG. 13.

[0049] FIG. 15—Plan view of the alternative embodiment of the lid depicted in FIG. 12.

[0050] FIG. 16—Front view of the alternative embodiment of the lid depicted in FIG. 15.

[0051] In the figures, the following reference numerals represent the corresponding component of the disclosed technology. [0052] **1000**—Wipes' container [0053] **1100**—Top rim of the wipes' container [0054] **2000**—Straightedge-cleaning lid [0055] **2100**—Annular base of the lid [0056]

2110—Annulus of the annular base [0057] **2120**—Catch on the rim of the annular base [0058] **2150**—Hinge connecting the base and cover plate [0059] **2200**—Cover plate of the lid [0060] **2210**—Annular projection on the lower surface of the cover plate [0061] **2220**—Latch on the lower surface of the cover plate [0062] **2230**—Catches on the upper surface of the cover plate [0063] **2240**—Outer ovular projections on the upper surface of the cover plate [0064] **2250**—Hinge connecting the cover plate and cleaning plate [0065] **2260**—Tab for gripping the cover plate [0066] **2270**—catch surface [0067] **2300**—Cleaning plate of the lid [0068] **2310**—Mouth on the cleaning plate [0069] **2311**—Teeth on the mouth of the cleaning plate [0070] **2312**—Tab for gripping the cleaning plate [0071] **2313**—Hinge connecting the tab and teeth on the mouth [0072] **2314**—latch for mouth that catches the catch surface of the cover plate. [0073] **2320**—Latches on the lower surface of the cleaning plate [0074] **2330**—Inner ovular projections on the lower surface of the cleaning plate [0075] **3000**—Wipes [0076] **4000**—User [0077] **5000**—Knife or straight edge to be cleaned

[0078] It is to be noted, however, that the appended figures illustrate only typical embodiments of this invention and are therefore not to be considered limiting of its scope, for the invention may admit to other equally effective embodiments that will be appreciated by those reasonably skilled in the relevant arts. Also, figures are not necessarily made to scale but are representative.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

[0079] Disclosed is a quick, on-the-spot, and safe method for cleaning knives between different food cuts. By combining a wipe container with a specially designed lid, the need for traditional cleaning methods is eliminated and the risk of injuries associated with handling knives directly may be mitigated. The layout of a lid for a wipes container or packaging is a key to the proposed lid's functionality. The lid suitably features an annular base that attaches securely to the top rim of the wipe container, enabling easy access to the wipes. A cover plate is hingedly connected to the base, providing a protective seal to close the container and safeguard the wipes from moisture, moisture-loss, and contaminants. Additionally, a cleaning plate is integrated into the cover plate, creating a convenient and safe platform for cleaning knives. The more specific details and utilities of the disclosure are described with reference to the attached figures.

[0080] FIG. 1A presents a perspective view of the lid **2000** and associated container **1000** of wipes. The assembled lid **2000** and container **1000** present an innovative all-in-one knife or straightedge sanitation solution. The assembly consists of two main components: a wipes' container **1000** and a straightedge-cleaning lid **2000**. The container **1000** features a tubular design, while the lid **2000** takes the form of a circular disk. The lid **2000** is ingeniously folded via two hinges and comprises the following elements:

[0081] Annular Base (**2100**): The annular base securely attaches to the top rim **1100** of the wipes' container **1000**. This attachment enables the controlled dispensing of individual wipes through the annulus of the base **2100**.

[0082] Cover Plate (**2200**): The cover plate **2200** is hingedly connected to the annular base **2100**. The plate **2200** serves as a protective cover, concealing the annulus of the base **2100** when closed, thereby safeguarding the wipes disposed within the container **1000**.

[0083] Cleaning Plate (**2300**): The cleaning plate **2300** is also hingedly connected, but to the cover plate **2200**. The plate **2300** cooperates with the cover plate to create opposing surfaces for knife wiping and sanitation.

[0084] FIGS. 1B & 1E depict the container **1000** and lid **2000** in a Closed Configuration. In these perspectives, the lid **2000** is particularly depicted in a closed configuration. The straightedge-cleaning lid **2000** securely encloses the wipes' container **1000**, providing comprehensive protection for the wipes and preventing any potential leakage of moisture or air. FIG. 1B demonstrates the opening direction indicated by an arrow, and in the opposite direction (FIG. 1D), the lid closes over the annulus of the base **2100** when the latch and catch components associate with each other.

[0085] FIGS. 1C & 1D depict the lid **2000** in an Open Configuration. In these perspectives, the

cover plate **2200** is in an open configuration relative to the base **2100**. The annulus **2110** of the annular base **2100** is exposed, allowing for easy and controlled dispensing of sanitation wipes **3000** through the annulus **2110**. The lower surface of the cover plate **2200** features an annular projection **2210**, which effectively interfaces with the annulus **2110**, ensuring a moisture and airtight seal to protect the wipes **3000** within the container.

[0086] Additionally shown in FIGS. **1C** & **D** is that the lower surface of the cover plate **2200** is equipped with a latch **2220**, which corresponds to a catch **2120** on the rim of the annular base **2100**. This latch **2220** and catch **2120** mechanism ensures a secure closure of the lid **2000** until disconnected. Furthermore, a user-friendly tab **2260** provides a comfortable grip on the cover plate **2200**, allowing users to apply force and hinge the cover plate around the cover plate-to-base hinge (**2150**). This interaction enables the easy opening of the container **1000** (arrow in FIG. **1B**) for access to the wipes. When the tab is interacted with in the opposite direction (arrow in FIG. **1D**), the lid closes over the annulus of the base when the latch and catch associate with one another.

[0087] FIG. **2A** is a perspective view of the lid **2000** in a closed configuration. FIG. **2B** is a perspective view of the lid **2000** with the cleaning plate **2300** in an open configuration. In FIG. **2A**, the straightedge-cleaning lid **2000** is in a closed configuration relative to the base **1000**. The lid **2000** securely encloses the wipes' container, providing comprehensive protection and sanitation for the wipes within. In FIG. **2B**, the cleaning plate **2300** is shown in an open configuration relative to the cover plate **2200**. In this view, the top surface of the cover plate **2200** is exposed, as is the bottom surface of the cleaning plate **2300**. Suitably, the top surface of the cover plate **2200** exhibits a series of outer ovular projections **2240**, which are parallelly positioned along a secant or chord of the circular disk's top surface. Similarly, the bottom surface of the cleaning plate **2300** features inner ovular projections **2330**, arranged parallelly along a different secant or chord of the circular disk that is the cleaning plate's **2300** bottom surface. These projections **2330/2240** play a role in facilitating a secure closure of the lid **2000** when not in use because the inner ovular projections **2330** sit between the outer projections **2240** of the cleaning plate. Moreover, the lower surface of the cleaning plate **2300** boasts two latches **2320**, designed to interlock with corresponding catches **2230** on the top surface of the cover plate **2200**. This locking mechanism ensures that the cleaning plate **2300** remains closed until the latches **2320** and catches **2230** are disconnected, providing a firm seal to keep the wipes' container streamline.

[0088] As shown in FIGS. **2A** and **2B**, a user-friendly tab **2312** is thoughtfully provided, allowing for a comfortable grip on the cleaning plate **2300**. This tab **2312** permits users to apply force and effortlessly hinge the cleaning plate around the cleaning plate-to-cover plate hinge **2250**. By interacting with the tab **2312** as indicated by the arrow in FIG. **2A**, users can conveniently open the straightedge cleaning lid **2000** and access the wipes **3000** and the cleaning plate **2300** for knife sanitation. Conversely, when the tab is interacted with in the opposite direction (not shown), the cleaning plate **2300** closes over the cover plate **2200**, ensuring a streamline container whenever the latches **2320** and catches **2230** associate with each other. This situation guarantees that the container **1000** remains compact and portable during transportation, suitable for use in professional and home kitchens alike.

[0089] FIG. **3** provides a top perspective view of the lid **2000** in completely unfolded configuration. The cover plate **2200** and cleaning plate **2300** are both open, revealing their respective surfaces. FIG. **4** presents a top plan view of the lid shown in FIG. **3**. This view showcases the top surface of the cleaning plate **2300**, the bottom surface of the cover plate **2200** with the annular projection **2210**, and latch **2220**, as well as the annulus **2110** of the base **2100** and the catch **2120**. These elements collectively contribute to the functionality and effectiveness of the lid, ensuring secure closure, effective sanitation, and protection of the wipes during use and transportation. Through these figures, the images demonstrate a superior layout, ease of use, and exceptional utility as a portable and efficient all-in-one knife sanitation solution. Its compatibility with various packaging styles, as represented in the reference numerals and components, reinforces

its versatility and potential in the culinary industry.

[0090] FIG. 5 is a bottom perspective view of the cover plate in an open confirmation and cleaning plate in an open configuration. FIG. 6 is a bottom plan view of the lid **2000** in an open configuration of the cover plate **2200** and open configuration of the cleaning plate **2300**. These figures illustrate the underside of the cleaning plate **2300** including the latches **2320** and inner ovular projections **2330**, the upper surface of the cover plate **2200** including the catches **2230** and outer ovular projections **2240**, and the undercarriage of the base **2100** for coupling the base **2100** to the upper rim **1100** (not shown-see FIG. 1) of the container **1000** (not shown see FIG. 1).

[0091] FIGS. 3-6 suitably shows that the cover plate to cleaning plate hinge **2250** is located 90 degrees away from the cover plate to base hinge **2150** when taken from a radial position around the circular disk of the cover plate **2200**. Suitably, this arrangement of the lid at 90-degree intervals around the cover plate **2200** ensures that the tabs **2260** and **2312** do not conflict with each other. The hinge position allows the cleaning plate and cover plates to hinge in transverse directions. Although depicted at 90 degrees in the preferred embodiment, the hinges can be offset radial by any oblique angle without conflicting with each other during operation.

[0092] The lid's **2000** unique layout, featuring a dual-hinged lid, annular base, cover plate, and cleaning plate, offers an all-in-one solution for knife sanitation. Its innovative features and portability make it a convenient and effective tool for chefs and home cooks to maintain a hygienic and safe cooking environment. The apparatus's compatibility with various packaging styles, as represented in the reference numerals and components, further emphasizes its versatility and potential in the culinary industry.

[0093] FIGS. 7A & 7B present another perspective view of the lid **2000**. The figures showcase the straightedge-cleaning lid **2000** in a closed configuration relative to the base **1000**. Meanwhile, FIGS. 7C & 7D offer another perspective of a container, featuring the straightedge-cleaning lid **2000** in an open configuration relative to the cover plate **2200**. In these views, the top surface of the cover plate **2200** is exposed, as is the cleaning plate's bottom surface, allowing users easy access to the wipes and cleaning plate for knife sanitation. FIGS. 7A through 7D illustrate operation of the mouth **2310** of the cleaning plate **2300**. It should be noted that the tab **2311** has a latch **2314** that interacts with cover plate's **2200** catch edge **2270** to keep the mouth closed when the lid is in a closed state. **2330**.

[0094] In FIGS. 7A & 7C, the cleaning plate's mouth **2310** is in a closed position, with the tab **2312** and teeth **2311** approximately aligned on the same plane as the cleaning plate **2300**. This configuration ensures that the mouth **2310** remains shut. FIGS. 7B & 7D depict the tab **2312** hinged relative to the teeth **2311**, allowing the mouth **2310** to open. This operation of a hinge **2313** facilitates attachment of the wipes **3000** to the cleaning plate **2300** so that knives or straightedges can be cleaned.

[0095] FIGS. 8A & 8B illustrate operation of the cleaning plate mouth prior to straightedge cleaning. In FIG. 8A, the lid **2000** is in an open configuration relative to the cover plate **2200**. In this state, the cleaning plate's mouth **2310** is also open, exposing the teeth **2313** for use. Prior to cleaning a straightedge, a wipe **3000** is preferably placed over the upper surface of the cover plate **2200**, extending to the underside of the cleaning plate where the mouth **2310** is open. The teeth **2313** are exposed, providing a gripping surface for securely holding the wipe in place in that situation. FIG. 9B illustrates the cleaning plate **2300** mouth **2310** being closed with the wipe **3000** securely held in its situation. In FIG. 9B, the cleaning plate's mouth **2310** is closed, with the teeth **2313** and tab **2312** securely gripping and holding the wipe **3000** in place in its spread-out orientation. This configuration ensures that the wipe remains in position during the cleaning process. The ability to securely hold wipes during use enhances the overall convenience and effectiveness of the technology in professional and home kitchen settings.

[0096] FIGS. 9, 10A & 10B illustrate cleaning a knife or straightedge via the cleaning and cover plates. As shown in FIG. 9, a knife or straight edge **5000** is positioned on the cover plate **2200** such

that the knife extends across the cover plate and such that the knife or straightedge spans the outer ovular projections. As shown in FIG. 10A, the cleaning plate may be closed relative to the cover plate such that the knife or straight edge is sandwiched between the two plates and the wipe 3000 is folded over the knife or straight edge. Both the inner and outer ovular projections on the cover plate and cleaning plate, respectively, are composed of rubber or other malleable materials. This smart design choice allows the projections to adapt to the slanted surfaces of the knife or straight edge, forming a seamless wiping interface and ensuring comprehensive sanitation. As shown in FIGS. 10A and 10B the knife may be pulled from the sandwiched configuration such that the food stuff or waste on the knife edge is wiped off to within the wipe. Through this innovative knife sanitation process, the lid seemingly guarantees a pristine and hygienic blade for the next use. The integration of the cleaning and cover plates ensures an all-in-one solution, combining the convenience of wipes with a secure mechanism to efficiently sanitize knives or straight edges.

[0097] In use, the device has the following method:

Step 1—Refer to FIG. 1A and see the step of opening the straightedge-cleaning lid 2000 by lifting the cover plate 2200 away from the annular base 2100 using the tab 2260. The latch 2220 disengages from the corresponding catch on the rim of the annular base.

Step 2—refer to FIG. 8A and see the step of laying out a sanitation wipe 3000 over the upper surface of the cover plate 2200 and the underside of the cleaning plate 2300, with the cleaning plate mouth 2310 open and the teeth 2313 exposed.

Step 3—referring to FIG. 8B, step 3 is biting the wipe via closing the cleaning plate mouth 2310 by hinging the tab 2312 relative to the teeth 2311 such that the wipe 3000 is secured with the teeth 2311 of the cleaning plate 2300.

Step 4—Refer to FIG. 9 to see the step of carefully placing the knife or straight edge 5000 on the cover plate 2200 so that the blade 5000 extends across the cover plate 2200 and spans the outer ovular projections 2240.

Step 5—Refer to FIG. 10A to see that, with the wipe 3000 secured in the cleaning plate's mouth 2310, the step of closing the cleaning plate 2300 relative to the cover plate 2200 is accomplished such that the wipe 3000 is neatly folded over the knife, creating a secure “sandwich” with the knife 5000 safely held between the two plates.

Step 6—step 6 is wiping off residue (Refer to FIGS. 10A & 10B) via gently pulling the knife 5000 from the sandwiched configuration such that the inner and outer ovular projections adapt to the slanted surfaces of the knife or straight edge, effectively wiping off any food residue or waste from the knife's edge onto the wipe 3000.

Step 7—Refer to FIGS. 7A & 7B to see the step of the knife or straight edge 5000 being sanitized.

[0098] The disclosed straightedge-cleaning lid 2000 has a utility that is a versatile solution for knife sanitation, ensuring safety and hygiene during culinary tasks. The lid 200 can be readily adapted and used with different wipes packaging options, offering a portable and efficient apparatus for all-in-one knife sanitation needs. For instance, FIG. 11 is an alternative embodiment of the knife or straightedge cleaning lid 2000 that can be used on a pouch or packet of wipes. See, e.g., U.S. Pat. No. 10,334,998 (issued Jul. 2, 2019) by Rubo et al. (incorporated by reference). The lid 2000 of FIG. 11 has all the same components as the lid 2000 shown in FIGS. 1 through 10B. However, the lid in FIG. 11 is rectangular. FIG. 12 is a top perspective view of the lid 2000 of FIG. 11 and shows the top of the cleaning plate 2300, the bottom of the cover plate 2200, and the upper side of the base 2100. FIG. 13 is a bottom perspective of the lid 2000 and shows the underside of the cleaning plate 2300, the top side of the cover plate 2200, and the undercarriage of the base 2100. FIG. 14 is a side view of the lid 2000 depicted in FIG. 13. FIG. 15 is a plan view of the Lid 2000 depicted in FIG. 12. FIG. 16 is a front view of the lid 2000 depicted in FIG. 15.

[0099] Although the method and apparatus is described above in terms of various exemplary embodiments and implementations, it should be understood that the various features, aspects, and functionality described in one or more of the individual embodiments are not limited in their

applicability to the particular embodiment with which they are described, but instead might be applied, alone or in various combinations, to one or more of the other embodiments of the disclosed method and apparatus, whether or not such embodiments are described and whether or not such features are presented as being a part of a described embodiment. For example, the disclosed lid may be adapted for use in any of the packing identified in the following documents: [0100] U.S. Pat. No. 3,982,659 (issued 1976 Sep. 28) by Ross discloses a “bulk package for substantially wet sheets and dispensing devices therefor.” [0101] U.S. Pat. No. 4,185,754 (issued 1980 Jan. 29) by Jilius discloses a “collapsible recloseable dispenser packet with two-part resealable closure.” [0102] U.S. Pat. No. 5,040,680 (issued 1991 Aug. 20) by Wilson et al. discloses a “dispensing container.” [0103] U.S. Pat. No. 5,699,912 (issued 1997 Dec. 23) by Ishikawa et al. discloses a “container for wetted tissues.” [0104] U.S. Pat. No. 6,092,690 (issued 2000 Jul. 25) by Bitowft et al. discloses a “wet-wipe container having a hinged cover.” [0105] U.S. Pat. No. 6,394,298 (issued 2002 May 28) by Zaidman discloses a “dispensing cover.” [0106] U.S. Pat. No. 6,951,292 (issued 2005 Oct. 4) by Bando et al. discloses a “container with hinged lid.” [0107] U.S. Pat. No. 8,893,911 (issued 2014 Nov. 25) by Damaghi et al. discloses a “dispenser lid and container including the same.” [0108] U.S. patent Ser. No. 10/334,998 (issued 2019 Jul. 2) by Rubo et al. discloses a “flexible container and reusable closure element.” [0109] U.S. Des. Pat. No. D414637 (issued 1999 Oct. 5) by Amundson et al. discloses a “container for wipes.” [0110] U.S. Des. Pat. No. D545097 (issued 2007 Jun. 26) by Schlaupitz et al. discloses a “container for wipes.” [0111] U.S. Des. Pat. No. D967706 (issued 2022 Oct. 25) by Dern et al. discloses a “container lid.” [0112] U.S. Pub. App. No. US20060054517 (published 2006 Mar. 16) by Albert discloses a “wipe storage system.” See front page: [0113] U.S. Pub. App. No. US20080099596 (published 2008 May 1) by DeMaso et al. discloses “oval wipes. container.” [0114] U.S. Pub. App. No. US20050039293 (published 2005 Feb. 24) by McReynolds et al. discloses a “dispenser assembly for dispensing liquid onto a removable sheet contained by an implement.” [0115] U.S. Pub. App. No. US20080179326 (published 2008 Jul. 31) by Krauth et al. discloses a “push button dispensing lid.” Thus, the breadth and scope of the claimed invention should not be limited by any of the above-described embodiments.

[0116] Terms and phrases used in this document, and variations thereof, unless otherwise expressly stated, should be construed as open-ended as opposed to limiting. As examples of the foregoing: the term “including” should be read as meaning “including, without limitation” or the like; the term “example” is used to provide exemplary instances of the item in discussion, not an exhaustive or limiting list thereof; the terms “a” or “an” should be read as meaning “at least one,” “one or more,” or the like; and adjectives such as “conventional,” “traditional,” “normal,” “standard,” “known,” and terms of similar meaning should not be construed as limiting the item described to a given time period or to an item available as of a given time, but instead should be read to encompass conventional, traditional, normal, or standard technologies that might be available or known now or at any time in the future. Likewise, where this document refers to technologies that would be apparent or known to one of ordinary skill in the art, such technologies encompass those apparent or known to the skilled artisan now or at any time in the future.

[0117] The presence of broadening words and phrases such as “one or more,” “at least,” “but not limited to,” or other like phrases in some instances shall not be read to mean that the narrower case is intended or required in instances where such broadening phrases might be absent. The use of the term “assembly” does not imply that the components or functionality described or claimed as part of the module are all configured in a common package. Indeed, any or all the various components of a module, whether control logic or other components, might be combined in a single package or separately maintained and might further be distributed across multiple locations.

[0118] Additionally, the various embodiments set forth herein are described in terms of exemplary block diagrams, flow charts, and other Illustrations. As will become apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art after reading this document, the illustrated embodiments and their various

alternatives might be implemented without confinement to the illustrated examples. For example, block diagrams and their accompanying description should not be construed as mandating a particular architecture or configuration.

[0119] All original claims submitted with this specification are incorporated by reference in their entirety as if fully set forth herein.

Claims

1. A method of knife or straight edge sanitation comprising: securing a cover plate that is hingedly connected to a cleaning plate; obtaining a sanitation wipe; laying out the sanitation wipe over an upper surface of the cover plate and the underside of the cleaning plate; opening a mouth of the cleaning plate to expose at least one tooth of the cleaning plate; securing the wipe by closing the cleaning plate's mouth; placing a knife or straight edge on the cover plate such that the blade spans outer projections of the cover plate; closing the cleaning plate relative to the cover plate such that knife is held between said cleaning and cover plates and such that the knife interfaces said outer projections and at least one inner projection of the cleaning plate; pulling the knife out from between the cleaning and cover plates; opening the mouth of the cleaning plate; discarding the wipe with food residue or waste of the knife disposed within the wipe.
2. The method of claim 1 further comprising the step of disengaging a latch of the cover plate from a corresponding catch.
3. The method of claim 2 wherein the step of securing the wipe by closing the cleaning plate's mouth is accomplished via hinging a tab of the cleaning plate relative to the at least one tooth of the cleaning plate.
4. The method of claim 3 wherein the step of closing the cleaning plate relative to the cover plate accomplishes a further step of folding the wipe over the knife.
5. The method of claim 4 wherein the step of closing the cleaning plate relative to the cover plate precedes a further step of allowing the inner and outer projections to adapt to slanted surfaces of the knife or straight edge.
6. The method of claim 5 wherein the step of pulling the knife out from between the cleaning and cover plates accomplishes the further step of wiping off food residue or waste from the blade onto the wipe, and sanitizing the knife or straight edge using cleaning and sanitization solution in the wipes.
7. An apparatus for knife or straight edge sanitation, comprising: a cover plate (**2200**); a cleaning plate (**2300**) hingedly connected to the cover plate; a mouth (**2310**) on the cleaning plate with at least one tooth (**2311**) for securing a sanitation wipe; outer projections (**2240**) on the cover plate for supporting the knife or straight edge; inner projections on the cleaning plate for abutting the knife or straight edge through a sanitation wipe when the mouth secures the sanitation wipe and when the cleaning plate is closed relative to the cover plate; wherein the inner and outer projections are constructed of malleable material for adapting the inner and outer ovular projections to slanted surfaces of the knife or straight edge through the sanitation wipe when the mouth secures the sanitation wipe and when the cleaning plate is closed relative to the cover plate; wherein pulling the knife or straight edge out from between the cleaning and cover plates when the mouth secures the sanitation wipe and when the cleaning plate is closed relative to the cover plate results in contaminants on the knife or straight edge being retained on the wipe.
8. A knife cleaning apparatus comprising: a cover plate; a cleaning plate hingedly connected to the cover plate such that a surface of the cleaning plate and a surface of the cover plate are adjacent to one another when the cleaning plate and cover plate are set in a closed configuration; where a wipe is folded and disposed between the cleaning plate and the cover plate in a closed configuration; and, wherein a knife or straight edge may be disposed within a fold of the folded wipe disposed between the cleaning plate and the cover plate in the closed configuration.

- 9.** The apparatus of claim 8 wherein food contaminants from the knife are disposed within the fold of the folded wipe disposed between the cleaning plate and the cover plate in the closed configuration.
- 10.** The method of claim 6 wherein the step of pulling the knife out from between the cleaning and cover plates accomplishes the further step of protecting at least one finger from the blade of the knife.
- 11.** The method of claim 10 wherein the step of protecting at least one finger from the blade of the knife is accomplished via holding the finger against the upper surface of the cleaning plate.
- 12.** The method of claim 10 wherein the finger may apply further pressure against a top surface of the cleaning plate.
- 13.** The apparatus of claim 8 further comprising a base of the coverplate that is annular.
- 14.** The apparatus of claim 8 further comprising a base that is rectangular.
- 15.** The method of claim 1 where the cover plate features a base that is annular.
- 16.** The method of claim 1 where the cover plate features a base that is rectangular.
-